



Q

What is the minimum vinegar acidity required for safe home pickling to prevent bacterial growth such as *Clostridium botulinum*?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

5% acidity vinegar

FUN FACT

Using vinegar with at least 5% acidity is critical for safe pickling at home.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

Why should you never reduce the amount or acidity of vinegar in a tested pickling recipe?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

It may allow growth of harmful bacteria and spoilage.

FUN FACT

Altered vinegar amounts can compromise food safety in pickling.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What is the recommended headspace to leave in jars when pickling vegetables?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

1/2 inch headspace

FUN FACT

Proper headspace ensures proper sealing and safe preservation.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Adults

Q

For fermenting sauerkraut or kimchi, which type of container is safest to use?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

Food-grade ceramic crock or glass jars

FUN FACT

Non-food grade containers may contaminate fermentation and cause spoilage.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Adults

Q

What is the standard salt concentration used in the brine for fermenting cabbage to make sauerkraut?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

1 1/2 tablespoons salt per 1 quart water

FUN FACT

Salt helps to control the fermentation process by favoring good bacteria.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Adults

Q

When pickling green beans, what is an optional ingredient you can add to jars for flavor?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

Dill heads or basil sprigs

FUN FACT

Fresh herbs enhance flavor without affecting safety if used properly.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

Why should cucumbers have about 1/16 inch cut off the blossom end before pickling?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

To improve firmness by removing enzymes that cause softening

FUN FACT

Removing the blossom end helps produce crisper pickles.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Adults

Q

What is a safe processing time for hot-pack pints of pickled beans at altitudes above 6,000 feet?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

**15 minutes in boiling water
canner**

FUN FACT

*Processing time increases with
altitude to ensure safety.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What type of salt should be used in pickling and fermenting to ensure safety and proper fermentation?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

Canning or pickling salt

FUN FACT

Pickling salt is free of anti-caking agents that can cloud brines or cause fermentation issues.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

When fermenting kimchi, why is it important to rinse and drain the salted cabbage before mixing with spices?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

To remove excess salt that could inhibit fermentation

FUN FACT

Proper rinsing allows lactic acid bacteria to develop safely during fermentation.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs



Q

How long should cucumbers be soaked in lime-water solution for firmer pickles?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

12 to 24 hours soaking

FUN FACT

Pickling lime improves firmness but must be thoroughly rinsed before pickling.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Adults

Q

What should you avoid using as utensils for pickling and fermenting to prevent metal reactions?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

Zinc, copper, brass, galvanized metal, or iron

FUN FACT

Certain metals react with acids or salt, harming pickle quality and safety.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What is the purpose of leaving cucumbers submerged 1 to 2 inches under the brine during fermentation?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

Prevent exposure to air that causes mold and spoilage

FUN FACT

Proper submersion creates an anaerobic environment needed for safe fermentation.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

Why is it necessary to process jars in a boiling water canner after hot-pack pickling?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

**To kill spoilage
microorganisms and seal jars
safely**

FUN FACT

*Boiling water processing ensures safe
shelf storage of acidic pickles.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Adults

Q

What is a common symptom if vinegar acidity is too low or insufficient vinegar is used in pickling?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

Off-odors, soft texture, and spoilage

FUN FACT

Insufficient acidity allows harmful bacteria to grow and spoil the food.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

How should jars be handled after boiling water canning and before storage?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

Cool undisturbed for 12 to 24 hours then check seals

FUN FACT

Proper cooling ensures vacuum seals form correctly for safe storage.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What is the correct salt to water ratio for making brine to ferment vegetables safely?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

1 1/2 tablespoons salt per 1 quart water

FUN FACT

Salinity controls microbial growth during fermentation for safety and flavor.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Adults

Q

When pickling mushrooms, what vinegar acidity is recommended for safe preservation?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

5% acidity vinegar

FUN FACT

Using 5% vinegar prevents harmful bacterial growth in pickled mushrooms.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What is the safe pH range vinegar must provide for home pickled vegetables to inhibit botulism?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

pH below 4.6

FUN FACT

Low pH creates an acidic environment that prevents dangerous bacteria growth.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

How long should freshly packed sauerkraut or fermented pickles be stored after processing for best flavor development?

PICKLING



Adults

ANSWER

4 to 5 weeks

FUN FACT

Flavor improves as fermentation continues slowly during storage.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables